
Which Southeast Asian market first?

Market-entry recommendation · hypothetical company, real World Bank data

Head of Growth (hypothetical company) · 2026-10-04

Launch in Indonesia first, and let a six-week paid test confirm it before full spend

- 1 **Indonesia is the largest reachable market: 206M internet users, 2.4 times Vietnam's**

- 2 **Adjusted for income, Indonesia's online market is at least twice that of any other candidate**

- 3 **Vietnam is the best backup: the fastest-growing economy, but under half Indonesia's online audience**

- 4 **Whether we can win is unproven in every market, so a six-week paid test should gate the full launch**

Indonesia has 206M internet users, 2.4 times Vietnam's and over 3 times Thailand's

Planned exhibit: bar — internet users by country, 2024, millions (Indonesia highlighted)

Layout: exhibit_takeaways

Evidence needed

- E1 Population 2024: Indonesia 283.5M, Vietnam 101.0M, Philippines 115.8M, Thailand 71.7M [SRC 1]
- E2 Individuals using the internet, % of population, 2024: Indonesia 72.8, Vietnam 84.2, Philippines 67.3, Thailand 90.9 [SRC 2]
- E3 Internet users 2024: Indonesia 206.3M, Vietnam 85.0M, Philippines 77.9M, Thailand 65.1M [CALC]
- E4 Indonesia's internet users vs others: 2.43× Vietnam, 2.65× Philippines, 3.17× Thailand [CALC]

Indonesia also added the most users since 2019 (+76M) and still has 77M people offline

Planned exhibit: stacked bar — population online vs offline by country, 2024, millions

Layout: exhibit_takeaways

Evidence needed

- E5 Internet users 2019: Indonesia 130.0M, Vietnam 66.7M, Philippines 47.7M, Thailand 47.7M [CALC]
- E6 Internet users added 2019-2024: Indonesia +76.4M, Philippines +30.2M, Vietnam +18.3M, Thailand +17.5M [CALC]
- E7 Offline population 2024: Indonesia 77.2M, Philippines 37.9M, Vietnam 16.0M, Thailand 6.5M [CALC]

Income per person in Indonesia matches Vietnam's and trails only Thailand's

Planned exhibit: bar — GDP per capita, PPP, 2024, current international \$

Layout: exhibit_takeaways

Evidence needed

- E8 GDP per capita, PPP, current international \$: 2024 Thailand 24,909, Indonesia 16,472, Vietnam 16,388, Philippines 11,814... [SRC 3]

Adjusted for income, Indonesia's online market is at least twice that of any other candidate

Planned exhibit: bar — internet users × GDP per capita (PPP), 2024, international \$ trillion

Layout: exhibit_takeaways

Evidence needed

- E9 Online purchasing-power proxy 2024 (internet users × GDP per capita PPP), international \$ trillion: Indonesia 3.40, Thailand 1.62, Vietnam 1.39... [CALC]
- E10 Indonesia's proxy vs others: 2.10× Thailand, 2.45× Vietnam, 3.70× Philippines [CALC]

Vietnam is the best backup: the fastest-growing economy, but under half Indonesia's online audience

Planned exhibit: highlight table — GDP growth 2025, average GDP growth 2021-2025, income growth 2019-2025, internet users 2024, by country

Layout: table

Evidence needed

- E11 Real GDP growth 2025: Vietnam 8.0%, Indonesia 5.1%, Philippines 4.4%, Thailand 2.4%... [SRC 4]
- E12 GDP per capita PPP growth 2019-2025: Vietnam +64%, Indonesia +47%, Philippines +41%, Thailand +31% [CALC]
- E13 Vietnam's internet users as share of Indonesia's: 41% [CALC]

Thailand is small and slow-growing, and the Philippines has the lowest income of the four

Planned exhibit: two columns — Thailand (fewest internet users, slowest growth) vs Philippines (lowest income per person)

Layout: two_column

Evidence needed

- E3 Internet users 2024: Indonesia 206.3M, Vietnam 85.0M, Philippines 77.9M, Thailand 65.1M [CALC]
- E8 GDP per capita, PPP, current international \$: 2024 Thailand 24,909, Indonesia 16,472, Vietnam 16,388, Philippines 11,814... [SRC 3]
- E11 Real GDP growth 2025: Vietnam 8.0%, Indonesia 5.1%, Philippines 4.4%, Thailand 2.4%... [SRC 4]

We cannot yet say if we can win: app spending, competition and acquisition cost are unknown

Planned exhibit: table — question × what we know × what is missing, for Indonesia and Vietnam

Layout: table

Evidence needed

- **[DATA NEEDED]** consumer spending on education / language-learning apps by country, US\$, latest year, from an app-market data provider; owner: Strategy
- **[DATA NEEDED]** top 5 language-learning apps by downloads and price per country, from app-store rankings; owner: Growth
- **[DATA NEEDED]** share of payments by method (card, e-wallet, carrier billing) per country, from payment-provider reports; owner: Finance
- **[DATA NEEDED]** data-protection and local-entity rules for consumer apps in Indonesia and Vietnam; owner: Legal

A six-week paid test in Indonesia and Vietnam answers those questions before full spend

Planned exhibit: process — localize store page and onboarding → run paid ads in both markets → measure install-to-paid conversion and cost per paying subscriber → decide

Layout: exhibit

Evidence needed

- **[DATA NEEDED] test budget and full-launch budget, US\$, from Finance; owner: CFO**
- **[DATA NEEDED] cost per paying subscriber in Indonesia and Vietnam, US\$, from the paid test; owner: Growth**

Approve the paid test now, and launch in Indonesia if acquisition cost meets our payback target

Planned exhibit: four actions with owner and timing

Layout: recommendations

Evidence needed

- E3 Internet users 2024: Indonesia 206.3M, Vietnam 85.0M, Philippines 77.9M, Thailand 65.1M [CALC]
- E9 Online purchasing-power proxy 2024 (internet users × GDP per capita PPP), international \$ trillion: Indonesia 3.40, Thailand 1.62, Vietnam 1.39... [CALC]
- **[DATA NEEDED] payback target for a new market, months, from Finance; owner: CFO**

Indicator table for the four markets, latest World Bank data

Planned exhibit: table — population, internet use %, internet users, GDP per capita PPP, GDP growth, working-age share, mobile subscriptions per 100

Layout: appendix

Evidence needed

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- +3 more items in storyline.md

The Philippines' internet-use rate fell 10.6 points in 2024, so treat its online count with caution

Planned exhibit: line — internet use % by country, 2015-2024

Layout: appendix

Evidence needed

- E14 Philippines internet use: 77.9% (2023) → 67.3% (2024), –10.6 points; 2023 users about 89M [SRC 2]
- **[DATA NEEDED] reason for the 2024 drop in the Philippines series (method change or real), from the ITU / World Bank series notes; owner: Strategy**